

Game Design Document

Game Title

False Conduct (working title)

Game Pitch

False Conduct will be a narrative-driven psychological role-playing game where the player takes control of a protagonist living with antisocial personality disorder. The game focuses on social interaction as its core gameplay system, placing the player in everyday scenarios where they must navigate conversations, relationships, and conflicts.

Unlike traditional games that rely on combat or clear moral choices, this game centres around manipulation, observation, and behavioural strategy. The player must imitate emotional responses, maintain social relationships, and manage how others perceive them, all while pursuing their own personal goals. The experience is designed to explore how social behaviour can be performed rather than naturally felt.

Game Pillars

Social Strategy as Gameplay - *The core of the game is turning social interaction into a strategic system. Conversations are not just for storytelling but act as gameplay encounters where the player must carefully choose how to respond based on the situation and the person they are speaking to.*

Mask vs Instinct - *A central mechanic that forces the player to choose between maintaining a believable social persona or acting on self-interest. This creates a weight between long term trust or short-term gain which encouraging thoughtful decision-making.*

Consequences and Perception - *Every action affects how characters perceive the player. Trust and suspicion systems ensure that behaviour has lasting consequences, shaping relationships and influencing the direction of the story.*

Game Platform

The game is designed primarily for PC as a single-player experience.

There are no plans for multiplayer functionality

Target Audience

The target audience for this game is players aged 16 and above due to its psychological themes and mature subject matter. It is aimed at players who enjoy story-driven experiences and games that focus on character interaction and choice.

This includes players who enjoy narrative-heavy games where decisions have meaningful consequences, as well as those interested in psychological storytelling and unique gameplay systems that differ from traditional games within a similar genre.

 Alex Carter Analytical player	Player Background Age – can be any age that is able to play games however most likely to target people aged 16-30 Gender – Anyone can play no matter the gender Location – The player can be from any cultural/ethnic background and still enjoy the game. The type of games the player enjoys – if a person is to be picking up this game, they are likely to enjoy many narrative and mystery games such as, Doki Doki Literature club, Danganronpa, Steins Gate, etc. As well as enjoying visual novels but desiring more challenge/interaction.
Gaming Motivations Alex likes to play games to experience unique stories and enjoy understanding characters and systems. They are also extremely motivated by games that allow them to use their critical thinking skills, and approach situations in multiple ways. Player Experience Goals For this game, Alex will want to feel as though they are challenged constantly to analyse situations and make calculated decisions that will affect them later down the line.	Frustrations With Existing Games This kind of player may have a frustration with games that are reliant on an online function which can lead to encountering others online which may bring a negative attitude or moment into Gillians day, which may make playing some games rather unenjoyable. Needs and Expectations for New Games This player wants a game that will be easy to play and has an interesting story and is looking for a good scare.

Story

The story focuses on the protagonist navigating everyday life and social environments while pursuing personal goals. Rather than a large, dramatic plot, the narrative is built from smaller interactions and decisions that gradually shape the overall experience.

The story is branching, meaning that different choices lead to different outcomes, relationships, and paths. Instead of a fixed storyline, the narrative evolves based on how the player behaves and how other characters respond.

World

The game takes place in grounded realistic setting in a small town known as Greyhaven. Whilst it is made to appear as calm and familiar on the surface, there are subtle ideas that reinforce the game's psychological themes.

The name Greyhaven reflects the core tone of the game. The word "grey" represents moral ambiguity and unclear intentions, while "haven" suggests a safe location. Together, they imply a place that feels uncertainly stable, which mirrors the game's focus on perception, behaviour, and hidden intent.

Character Backstory

The protagonist is an intelligent and observant person who struggles with emotional empathy due to ASPD. Due to this they have learned to navigate social situations by studying others and imitating expected behaviours.

Rather than forming genuine emotional connections, they approach relationships as systems to understand and manipulate when necessary. This creates a unique perspective where social interaction becomes a calculated process.

Look and Feel

Look

The game is presented in a Danganronpa-inspired visual novel style, featuring character portraits with expressive reactions, and scene-based presentation. Dialogue is central to the visual experience, with a strong emphasis on reading characters emotions, there needs to be a way to read them and so there's focus on facial expression, tone, and emotional cues.

The UI is clean and minimal, ensuring that focus remains on character interaction and decision-making. Visual feedback is used to represent systems such as trust and suspicion without overwhelming the player.

Feel

The game is designed to feel tense, psychological, and thought-provoking. The player should constantly feel aware of how they are being perceived, creating a sense of pressure during even simple conversations. At the same time, successful manipulation or correct interpretation of situations should feel rewarding and strategic.

Interface

The UI is inspired by visual novel systems, particularly games such as Danganronpa: Trigger Happy Havoc. Character portraits are displayed during dialogue, with text and response options appearing clearly on screen.

Additional systems are integrated into the UI, including emotional analysis information, trust and suspicion meters, and behavioural indicators tied to the Mask vs Instinct system. The design ensures that all gameplay systems are visible without cluttering the screen.

Game Objectives

The primary objective is to navigate social environments successfully by managing relationships, gathering information, and influencing outcomes. Progression is achieved through interaction rather than traditional combat or exploration mechanics.

The player's success depends on how effectively they can maintain their social mask while achieving personal goals.

Game Tokens

Instead of physical items, the game uses abstract systems such as trust, suspicion, and information as core resources. These values determine how NPCs respond to the player and which narrative paths become available.

Rules

- *The player will be in a quest-esque state from the start where they then use certain dialogue options to*

Features

- **Mask vs Instinct System**
 - *This system allows the player to choose between socially acceptable behaviour and self-serving responses. It creates a balance between maintaining relationships and pursuing efficiency.*
- **Dialogue System**
 - *A branching dialogue system where choices are based on intent rather than morality. Each option reflects a different behavioural strategy, such as manipulation, imitation of empathy, honesty, or emotional detachment.*
- **Emotional Analysis System**
 - *A mechanic that allows the player to observe and interpret NPC behaviour. This provides insight into emotional states, motivations, and vulnerabilities, which can be used to make more effective decisions.*
- **Trust and Suspicion System**
 - *NPCs dynamically track the player's behaviour. Trust increases through consistency and believable behaviour, while suspicion increases through manipulation or inconsistency. These values directly affect narrative progression and available interactions.*

Gameplay

The gameplay as previously mentioned will be like that of a visual novel meaning that the encounters and such passively come to the player.

60 Seconds of Game Play

The player enters a social scenario within Greyhaven, such as a classroom or workplace conversation. They begin by observing the other characters, using emotional analysis to understand their mood and intentions. The player is then presented with dialogue options based on different behavioural approaches. After selecting a response, NPCs react dynamically, adjusting trust and suspicion levels. The outcome of the interaction influences future conversations and available story paths.